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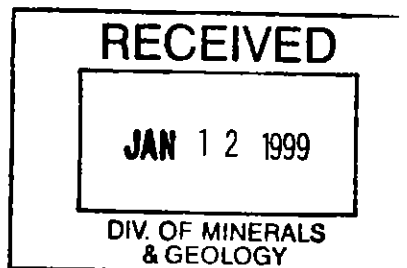


**St. Vrain Valley
Community Watchdogs**
neighbors united for clean air

P O Box 82/Hygiene/CO 80533-0082
online at www.geocities.com/~watchdogs

January 7, 1998

Ms. Gabi Hoefler
Boulder County Health Department
3450 Broadway
Boulder, CO 80304



M-77-208

Dear Ms. Hoefler,

We appreciated receiving a copy of John Lohr's correspondence to you dated 11/5/98. Mr. Lohr's sincerity is evident. However, regarding comments pertaining to the angle of sunlight vis-a-vis accuracy of evaluating particulate emissions opacity whether visible or invisible due to angle of incidence, quite simply put, the dust referred to by M.L. Dobbs is in the air we breathe as a matter of course during our daily activity as residents of the St. Vrain Valley and neighbors of Southdown. The low angle of the sun simply enhances the visibility of Southdown's daily and routine emissions.

During the months of November and December 1998, the Watchdogs called in several complaints to your Air Pollution Hot Line number regarding fugitive dust emissions at the Southdown facility. We deeply appreciate the control strategies that are being taken by Mr. Lohr to reduce and contain emissions, and we understand the frustration that the regulators must experience when they respond to a complaint and find nothing visible when they reach the plant. Please continue to take our concerns seriously because these emissions are real, and they are falling through the cracks of the regulatory process.

The enclosed photograph was taken in December of 1998. The incident was reported on the Hot Line. The plume that you see in the photograph persisted for approximately 30 minutes. It blew to the north, across Ute Highway and into residential areas. Unfortunately, at present, we are unable to identify the specific site at the plant where these plumes originate. We suspect that the plumes may contain cement kiln dust escaping from the disposal site and/or the wind is picking up portland cement debris from the plant's structures and dispersing it throughout the adjoining community.

Gabi, the Watchdogs are still waiting for the Air Pollution Control Division to provide us with a chemical characterization of these particulates and a determination if air-borne crystalline silica is present. Would your department be able to assist us in getting this information?

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Please continue to give this situation your top-priority attention. We are confident that aggressive monitoring and enforcement by the regulatory agencies now will harness these unregulated emissions and eliminate the imminent danger that this air pollution poses to our health and safety.

Thank you.

Sincerely,

111


Richard Cargill

for/St. Vrain Valley Community Watchdogs' Steering Committee

2 enclosures: photo and letter from Mr. Lohr

cc: Senator Ben Nighthorse Campbell

Mr. Mark Udall, US House of Representatives

Mr. Bill Owens, Governor

Ms. Dorothy Rupert, Colorado Senate

Mr. Todd Saliman, District 11, Colorado House of Representatives

Mr. Bill Swenson, District 12, Colorado House of Representatives

Ms. Carol Browner, Administrator of USEPA

Mr. William P. Yellowtail, Administrator, Region 8, USEPA

Mr. Richard Long, Director of Air Program, Region 8, USEPA

Ms. Mary Brown, Intergovernmental Relations

Mr. Robert Brady, Chairman, Air Quality Control Commission

Mr. Mike Mueller, Air Quality Control Commission

Ms. Patti Shwayder, Executive Director, CDPHE

Ms. Margie Perkins, Division Director, Air Pollution Control Division

Mr. Robert Jorgenson, Supervisor, Field Services Section, CDPHE

Mr. Dave Quimette, Stationary Sources Program Manager, APCD, CDPHE

Ms. Jeannette Hillery, President, Board of Health

Dr. Howie Wolf, Dr. William Marine, Ms. Beth Hartman, Board of Health

Mr. Chuck Stout, Boulder County Health Department

Mr. Stewart, Mr. Danish, Ms. Mendez, Boulder County Commissioners

Ms. Janine Pryor, American Lung Association

Mr. K. Lloyd, Regional Air Quality Council

Mr. C. Mount, Division of Minerals and Geology

Mr. Herb Gibson, Department of Labor, OSHA

Ms. Vickie Patton, Environmental Defense Fund

Ms. Leslie Kaas, Land and Water Fund of the Rockies

Mr. John Powers, President, Colorado Environmental Coalition

Director, Sierra Club

Mr. Brian Hansen, Environmental Writer, Colorado Daily

Mr. Richard Flerning, Editor, Boulder Weekly

Mr. Eric Frankowski, Environmental Writer, Daily Times Call

Mr. J. Gerwitz, Environmental Writer, Boulder Camera

Mr. B. Schroer, Environmental Writer, Denver Post

Mr. G. Kelly, Rocky Mountain News